

Maria Silva

38, Marlborough Road, Maidenhead, Berkshire · +447935308070 · mariafgsilva10@gmail.com ·
linkedin.com/in/mariafgsilva10

LLB and LLM graduate with practical experience supporting legal operations, data privacy compliance, document management and cross-functional coordination at a major international law firm, an in-house legal team and a legal clinic. Experienced in maintaining organised case and matter files, meeting deadlines across competing priorities, drafting and reviewing documents, and communicating with clients and external stakeholders. Familiar with UK GDPR and data protection compliance from research, advisory and in-house contexts. Looking to apply this background in a legal operations and governance support role.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit Sept 2024 – Oct 2025

Queen Mary University of London

- Modules in international arbitration, dispute resolution procedure, legal research and evidence analysis
- Dissertation: data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions
- Transnational Law and Governance Applied module (data privacy and democracy) — 75%

Law LLB — 2:1 Sept 2020 – June 2024

University College London

- Modules included Commercial Law, Company Law, Advanced Contract Law and Alternative Dispute Resolution

International Foundation Programme — Law and International Relations Sept 2019 – June 2020

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of a 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines across a complex investment arbitration matter
- Coordinated documents and tracked outstanding actions across the team in the lead-up to a significant submission deadline, becoming the only junior supporting the team at that stage
- Liaised with the client to gather required documents and coordinated with an external translator, managing the communication on both sides
- Drafted procedural orders and procedural histories; conducted legal research; amended sections of the Claimant's memorial
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across several matters with competing deadlines, maintaining matter records via iManage
- Assisted with court filings, hearing arrangements, and matter opening and closure administration
- Prepared electronic hearing bundles and supported skeleton argument and court materials preparation
- Conducted legal and factual research; tracked deadlines and assisted with cost comparisons across matters

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead

July 2026 – Present

Legal Adviser

- Manages matters from initial instruction through to submission: drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, and maintains confidential case records to deadline
- Interviews clients across welfare benefits, employment, housing, family, debt and consumer matters; takes factual statements and establishes chronologies
- Assesses eligibility against statutory and regulatory criteria; identifies evidential gaps; researches complex legal points
- Communicates procedural requirements and options clearly to clients, including those in vulnerable circumstances

Q-Legal · Remote**Oct 2024 – Jan 2025****Legal Adviser**

- Managed a data privacy matter from client instruction through to a formal written advice letter, under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations for a data-driven start-up, including children's personal data and adtech compliance
- Identified legal and compliance risks from the client's data processing activities and recommended practical mitigations
- Coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to meet the agreed deadline for delivery of advice

Adobe · London**June 2022 – Aug 2022****Legal Intern**

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border personal data transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and reconcile commercial objectives with legal risk
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; document review and electronic bundling software; case management and time-recording systems

Case and evidence management: Matter file organisation and maintenance; deadline tracking across competing priorities; hearing bundle preparation; procedural document drafting; confidential document handling